

Inna Popova - Student Experience Adviser

CONTACT

Inna Popova

- 027-392-0067
- innapv@gmail.com
- Auckland, New Zealand
- New Zealand Permanent Resident

SUMMARY

- Operations and programme coordination professional with experience creating structure in fast-evolving organisations and supporting people to feel connected, supported, and engaged.
- Experienced in planning and delivering programmes and events, coordinating cross-functional teams, and keeping delivery reliable during periods of growth and changing priorities.
- Strong stakeholder communication across multicultural environments, with a warm and respectful style that supports positive relationships with students, families, teams, and partners.
- Comfortable gathering feedback and improving workflows, documentation, and service delivery through practical process improvements.
- Currently supporting a New Zealand AI technology company across operations, procurement coordination, finance administration, facilities support, and internal communication.
- Confident learning new systems quickly and using digital tools, including Microsoft Office, to improve planning, communication, and administrative productivity.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Marie International School - Operations & Programme Coordination Lead / Head Administrator

Jan 2021 - Dec 2024 · full-time · International education, early childhood education

International school in Nishinomiya, Japan, experiencing rapid growth across multiple campuses with a threefold increase in enrolment and team size.

Highlights

- Progressed from Administrator to Assistant Teacher and then Head Teacher at a newly established school.
- Coordinated daily operations across 3+ functional areas, supporting consistent service delivery for 100+ students and families.
- Managed scheduling and workflow coordination for 20+ staff members, strengthening communication and alignment across campuses.
- Acted as primary liaison between leadership, staff, parents, partners, and suppliers, handling 50+ weekly enquiries with structured and timely communication.
- Coordinated 10+ cross-campus programmes, events, and initiatives, including large-scale events involving 150+ attendees and 20+ staff.

- Created surveys and gathered feedback to evaluate programme effectiveness and improve school flow.
- Supported onboarding and integration of new team members during rapid expansion, reinforcing scalable processes and service consistency.

Tech: Microsoft Office, ClassDojo, Instagram

Mindhive Limited / Mindhive Global - Operations & Business Support Coordinator

Jan 2025 - Present · contract · AI technology, machine vision, industrial quality systems

New Zealand technology company developing AI-powered machine vision systems for industrial quality assessment, defect detection, and grading.

Highlights

- Provide day-to-day operational, administrative, and coordination support across office operations, procurement, finance administration, and facilities.
- Coordinate purchasing activities, including supplier communication, quote collection, purchase order preparation, invoice follow-up, and delivery tracking.
- Liaise with internal teams, external suppliers, contractors, and service providers to support smooth workflows and timely issue resolution.
- Support finance administration through invoice management, quote tracking, and purchase order coordination using Xero and Dext.
- Contribute to improvements in internal documentation and operational processes in a fast-moving environment.

Tech: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Slack, Xero, Dext, Jira, AI-assisted tools

Takapuna Primary School - After School Care Assistant

Jan 2011 - Dec 2014 · part-time · Primary education, after-school care

Auckland primary school providing after-school care for students.

Highlights

- Provided after-school care support for primary-aged students.
- Incorporated arts and music activities into after-school programme delivery.
- Supported children during cross-cultural transition, helping students feel safe and settle into a new environment.

Independent Client Services & Programme Coordination - Self-Employed

Jan 2012 - Dec 2020 · contract · Tourism, hospitality, client services

Demand-driven independent service business in Japan delivering bespoke client programmes for international B2C and B2B clients.

Highlights

- Designed and delivered customised client programmes, managing end-to-end service coordination.
- Coordinated 5-10 external vendor bookings per programme to support smooth multi-provider delivery.

- Managed seasonal planning, expense tracking, and invoicing while maintaining supplier cost control.
- Analysed demand trends and adjusted service offerings based on seasonal patterns and operational capacity.
- Built referral networks and independent marketing channels that supported repeat and word-of-mouth business.

Translation & Content Operations Support - Freelance Translator

Jan 2008 - Dec 2012 · contract · Translation, content operations

Freelance translation and content localisation services for service-based and education-focused organisations.

Career Break - Parental Leave

Jan 2006 - Dec 2009 · career-break · N/A

Planned family leave period before re-entering client-facing service and operations roles.

Spartak Tour Ltd. - Outbound Tourism Manager

Jan 2003 - Dec 2006 · full-time · Outbound tourism, travel

Travel company in Khabarovsk, Russia, specialising in outbound international travel packages.

EDUCATION

- **Specialist Degree in Management (Socio-Cultural Services & Tourism)** - Pacific State University (Pacific National University), Khabarovsk, Russia (1998-2003)